



**AUTOMOTIVE SECTOR ENGAGEMENT ON THE EAC ASSEMBLING AND MANUFACTURING OF PRODUCTS
REGULATION, 2025
24TH FEBRUARY 2025
10:00 am UMA LUGOGO KAMPALA**

AGENDA

1. Opening prayer
2. Self-introduction
3. Communication from the chairman
4. Sensitization on the regulation and remarks by;
 - Ministry of Finance, Planning and Economic Development
 - Uganda Revenue Authority representative
 - Ministry of Trade representative
5. Reactions, Discussions and way forward

MEMBERS PRESENT.

No	NAME	DESIGNATION	CONTACT
1.	Bruce Lin	MD Double Q Co. Ltd	bruce@doubleq.co.ug 0775092633
2.	Francis Twinamatsiko	Ass. Commissioner Tax policy - MOFPED	fntwine@gmail.com 0772414061
3.	Jude Ochieng	Manager Policy & I.A - URA	j.ochieng@ura.go.ug



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6.	Gilbert Wavamunno	MD – Spear Motors Ltd	gilbertw@spearmotors.co.ug 0772707171
7.	Allan Ssenyondwa	Director policy & Advocacy UMA	directorpolicy@uma.or.ug 0784358654
8.	Racheal Ajambo	COO - SKENYA Motors(U) Ltd	coo@skenya.com 0788626686
9.	Kobe Xiao	V.P – Double Q	xiaohaoke@doubleq.co.ug 0772599936
10.	William Byamugisha	Engineer - MTIC	William.byamugisha@mtic.go.ug 0785587951
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12.	Emuria Charles	Registration incharge – Dura motors ltd	charlesemuria@gmail.com 0772682924
13.	Irene Ninsiima	Customs Tarrif - URA	ininsiima@ura.go.ug 0703461609
14.	Susan Walitu	Officer International Affairs - URA	shamba@ura.go.ug 0776373108
15.	Kamanzi Simon	Zhenxi power supply limited	zhenxipscold@gmail.com 0780769864



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17.	Roselyn Kyalisiima	Economist TPD - MoFPED	Roselyne.kyalisiima@finance.go.ug 0778672900
18.	CPA Hirak Bhansali	CFO – Simba Automotives	cfo@simbaautomotives.com 0706295741
19.	Busingye David	Office of director – Spear Group	busingyed@wavahwater.co.ug 0788032881
20.	David Otti	General manager – Victoria motors	d.otti@gmach.ug 0772509780
21.	Farzan Merali	Operations manager - KARAA	farzana@karaa.africa 0754727273
22.	Edwin Muhumuza	Country sales manager – CFAO Mobility	0312-301600
23.	Richard Musani	Head marketing – Double Q Co. Ltd	0782436021
24.	Leon Amutuhaire	Company Secretary – Virtus Global Security (VGS)	07849412207
25.	Micheal Kaija	Policy analyst - UMA	k.micheal@uma.or.ug 0783886381
26.	Akugizibwe Deogratias	UMA – sector coordinator	Deoa356@gmail.com 0774126361



MEETING MINUTES

#	MINUTE	RESPONSIBILITY
1.0	Minute 1: Opening prayer The chairperson asked a volunteer to lead in an opening prayer for the meeting to commence	UMA Secretariat.
2.0	Minute 2. Self-introduction Members introduced themselves by name, company and designation. Participants shared roles: Ministry of Finance, URA, UMA, assemblers, end-users. Focus on automotive manufacturing/supply chain expertise.	All present
3.0	Minute 3: Communication from the chairman. 3.1 The Chairman extended a warm welcome to all members present, expressing sincere appreciation for their consistent and active participation throughout the meeting and as well thanked officials from government for being present at the engagement he continued by urging absolutely everyone to jump in with active participation and honest input encouraging no holding back. 3.2 He flagged a key issue around warranting processes and gave a quick policy update to frame the meeting. Then he laid out a brief backstory of these EAC regulations first bubbled up back in 2013, mainly by the East African Community to tackle headaches around moving vehicles and parts smoothly across borders. 3.3 He informed that this regulation is for both motor vehicles and motorcycles with the aim of promoting local sourcing. He informed that now the pressure's on we need rock-solid justifications and potential amendments to sell to EAC partners, and he called for all present to dig into that 34-page document together, line by line to note anything and call for further discussions and reactions.	Chairperson UMA Mobility sector Mr. Bruce Lin



#	MINUTE	RESPONSIBILITY
4.0	Minute 4. Sensitization on the Regulation 4.1 The Commissioner started strong by thanking UMA for pulling all us sector players together in one room and emphasized that it was exactly what the sector needed. He laid it out plain that these regulations will kickstart on July 1, 2026, and there may not be no more postponement after all our past delays. He straight-up asked for inputs to spot and fix issues in the regulations so that businesses don't just survive but actually thrive under them. He threw out a pointed question: why would Uganda keep importing automotive raw materials for assembly and manufacturing when all these required materials are right here in the region? 4.2 Key Definitions; Assembler (needs approval authority; varying levels); CKD (generic parts for assembly, flexible vs. prior strict rules); Local Content (10% threshold); Localization (local manufacturing/after-sales). - Categories: Motor vehicles and motor cycles - Details Reviewed: Remissions, localization, no market access benefits without compliance, regional reciprocity (tax non-compliant imports where there is need for clear approval from some authority, and there are different manufacturing levels to qualify, so no more anyone just claiming it. CKD kits got a flexible new definition: basically any "heat consisting of patterns" for Completely knocked down parts used in assembling and manufacturing i.e. used to assemble a motorcycle or motor vehicles or finished product which is way less rigid than the old rules that demanded things like engine machining while SKD kits refer to Semi-knocked down kids used to assemble a motorcycle or motor vehicles or finished product	Commissioner, Ministry of Finance & URA Manager Policy



#	MINUTE	RESPONSIBILITY
	4.3 Local content is key at that 10% threshold for remission perks, meaning suspension, seats/frames, wheel rims, and more have to come from EAC partners. Localization means real local development making components, sub-assemblies, after-sales support, the whole ecosystem. 4.4 Categories are split smartly: motor vehicles and trailers on one side, motorcycles (including 2-3 wheelers and even electric bikes if they're motorized and hit over 25km/h) on the other, with zero emissions required for assembled bikes. Registration processes are crystal clear, remissions are spelled out, and there's no free ride on market access. 4.5 If one is not compliant, they will pay full taxes even on regional imports (like slapping duties on non-compliant vehicles). These rules come from a solid 10-year study foundation, complete with incentives for producing those listed parts locally.	



#	MINUTE	RESPONSIBILITY
5.0	Minute 5: Reactions, Discussions and way forward. 5.1 Members raised concerns about whether we can actually source ALL those required materials within the EAC, and even if we can, is there enough quantity and quality to go around? 5.2 Unpacking SKD and CKD kits across every level of assembling and manufacturing for both vehicles and motorcycles, with folks sharing gritty details like Chinese 1.1L engines crapping out after 4-5 months while 1.4L ones last three years, or how there's no clear list of regional suppliers for stuff like AGM batteries or convertible roofs heck, no one in the region even makes those yet. 5.3 Buses and commercial vehicles need separating from cars and motorcycles because windscreens are structural load-bearers in cars but not buses, upholstery is hyper-specialized (think standard for local buses vs. luxury Mercedes), and electric bikes technically count as motorcycles under international norms if motorized. 5.4 Industry input was missing when these regulations were first drafted, so now we're playing catch-up auditors will just enforce the checklist, meaning pay up or comply. Proposals flew to amend the regulations to say something like "at least 8 out of 20 items sourced regionally" with clear quantities and thresholds to build a counter-position with alternatives, link to local funds for motorcycle production; run verification exercises on suppliers. 5.5 Members aired out that the Country just isn't ready, capital intensive industry means compromises on quality, and need that supplier directory aired with name the companies, verify their output meets and standards, so assemblers know where to buy local instead of China. 5.6 Consensus landed on delaying implementation while we fix this collaboratively.	All present



ACTION MATRIX

S/N	ACTION	RESPONSIBILITY	TIMELINE
1	Draft a full position paper laying out the rationale for why government shouldn't hit 'implement' just yet make it a strong defense that eases real compliance burdens.	UMA Sector members	31 st March 2026
2	Launch a Kobo tool survey, send it to all members asking for specifics on materials they need by category (quality, quantity, everything) for motor vehicles, motorcycles, etc. This feeds straight into the position paper and capacity assessment for government submission.	UMA secretariat	13 th March 2026
3	UMA reaches out directly to manufacturers associations in Kenya and Tanzania to get detailed info on their companies and exactly what's being produced regionally, so we can plug sourcing gaps.	UMA secretariat	Ongoing
4	Conduct thorough research across the East African Community to gauge actual industry capacity who can supply to meet quality and quantities. Carry out optimization audits at various companies to break down and separate operations for different vehicle or motorcycle types being manufactured or assembled	UMA secretariat	Ongoing